



FEELING WEAK? SALINE ISN'T ALWAYS THE ANSWER

When the sun shines over the streets of Dhaka, and the air feels dense enough to swim through, one familiar ritual begins across the country: the saline season.

Feeling tired? Take a saline.

Got dizzy in the heat? Saline.

Need to work a double shift? Saline again.

In fact, some people believe that taking two or three saline a day will strengthen them, make them more energetic, and better equip them to survive the extreme heat.

Across Bangladesh, saline has quietly evolved from a medical fluid into a cultural cure-all. What once was reserved for illness or dehydration is now treated like an everyday health drink except it's not a drink, and it's not harmless when misused. Many don't know that too much saline can do more harm than good.



Saline in oral rehydration salts (ORS) or intravenous drips is a scientifically formulated mix of water, sugar, and electrolytes, especially sodium. It works wonders when someone is severely dehydrated, like after acute diarrhoea, vomiting, excessive sweating, heatstroke, or illness. But if the body isn't actually dehydrated, taking saline can disturb the natural balance inside cells. When someone takes in too much sodium from frequent saline use, their blood becomes too salty. This condition, known as hypernatremia, causes your cells to lose water and shrink. The result might feel confused, weak, nauseous, or worse, develop serious complications like seizures, especially if already have heart or kidney issues.

But how did we get here? The answer lies partly in how effective ORS is when genuinely needed. If someone is severely dehydrated, that little packet of salt and sugar can seem like a miracle. It gives quick results. So, the logic forms: if one helps you feel better, then more must make you stronger. Combine that with the local clinics offering saline drips casually, the spread of folk knowledge, and the sheer exhaustion of summer heat, and suddenly, saline becomes a go-to wellness ritual.

Yet the truth is, we don't need a drip to feel better in the heat. Clean drinking water, fresh fruit juices, lemon water with a pinch of salt and sugar, and regular rest are often more than enough. Watermelon, cucumber, and coconut water are nature's hydrating tools. Saline should be used under medical guidance, not based on guesswork or peer advice.

So, the next time someone suggests a saline drip to help you power through the heat, smile and say, "No thanks. I'll take a glass of water and some seasonal fruits instead."

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